CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 15: **The Making of a Scientist (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. How does the biography blend narrative and explanation? 1

(a) It uses poetry
(b) It lists facts
(c) It uses dialogue only
(d) It tells events while explaining scientific ideas

2. The phrase 'a feather in one's cap' applies to Richard's: 1

(a) science-fair success **(b)** ill health
(c) poor results **(d)** lost book

3. A reasoned limitation of the chapter might be that it: 1

(a) shows few failures or hardships **(b)** is too short in time
(c) is too poetic **(d)** has too many characters

4. The chapter implies that formal education alone is: 1

(a) not enough without personal exploration **(b)** enough
(c) harmful **(d)** useless

5. Which pair shows contrast? 1

(a) cat versus dog **(b)** north versus south
(c) assumption versus experimental result **(d)** day versus night

6. The inclusion of Dr Urquhart suggests that science is: 1

(a) a solitary pursuit only **(b)** a collaborative enterprise
(c) a business **(d)** a game

7. Which is the most appropriate word for the writer's tone? 1

(a) mournful **(b)** admiring **(c)** sarcastic **(d)** neutral

8. The words 'infer' and 'imply' differ in that: 1

(a) imply is a number
(b) they are identical
(c) to imply is to suggest; to infer is to conclude
(d) infer is a noun

9. Which is the best interpretation of 'the making of a scientist'? 1

(a) a punishment
(b) an accident
(c) a quick transformation
(d) a gradual shaping by experience and encouragement

10. The statement 'Richard's success was due to privilege alone' is: 1

(a) neutral
(b) not supported since the text stresses effort and curiosity
(c) proved
(d) supported

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is mimicry a good topic for a young scientist? 2

12. How does the chapter present the relationship between observation and theory? 2

13. Examine the role of questions in the chapter. 2

14. How might a teacher use this chapter to inspire students? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the importance of mentorship in science, using the chapter. 3

16. Write about the relevance of this chapter for students in India. 3

17. Evaluate the limitations of a biographical text as a source of scientific knowledge. 3

OR

How does the chapter illustrate that simple observations can lead to significant discoveries? 3

18. How is the idea of 'persistence' communicated without explicit statement? 3

OR

Discuss how the chapter would change if told in Richard's own voice. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on 'Nurturing scientific temper in schools', using Richard as an example. 5

OR

Discuss how the chapter connects science with everyday life. 5

20. Compare the different kinds of knowledge Richard gains (observational, experimental, theoretical). 5

OR

Imagine an interview with Richard's mother. Write the dialogue. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks